

In Dolphin file manager, right click on the file you wish to send. Use the *Encrypt* action to encrypt it using the public key of your friend.

A new file with *gpg* extension will be created. If you try to decrypt it, it will fail.

Send this file to your friend and ask him to send you an encrypted file.

Receive a mail with an encrypted file and download it.

Click on it in the Dolphin file browser and it will be decrypted. You will need to specify your pass phrase for the key you had created.

Try using it with more than one friend and you will notice one major difference. No matter how many people send you encrypted files, you need to remember only one pass phrase, which you alone have created. It is a tremendous convenience at a nominal effort. Also, you can

encrypt all types of files and not just PDF documents.

The original hope for a password-less Internet had been to issue digital certificates. However, issuing and managing them at the individual level is far too complex and expensive. Hence, the client-side authentication using certificates never took off. It may be of interest to users of Ubuntu that most of Mark Shuttleworth's wealth came from Thawte Consulting, which was primarily involved in digital certificates.

From a server's security perspective, users uploading their own public key is just as good as creating their own password. Now, if only there was a way to convince financial organisations to start offering GPG encryption as an option. **END** 

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com> and <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, or you can reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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